objective research on the history of Polish-Jewish relations. This phenomenon, however, cannot be attributed solely to Poland's Communist rulers. In anti-Communist émigré circles in the West, a similar state of affairs also obtained. As a matter of fact, the Communists borrowed (understandably with no attribution) much of the pathology of the prewar nationalist right, and even the most liberal-minded elements of society were in no rush to reevaluate the awkward history of Polish-Jewish relations.

In a 2013 lecture Jan Tomasz Gross explained:

> T]he Polish intelligentsia screened out what was happening on the lower rungs of Polish society from the narrative of Poland's wartime tragedy. Not so much because of its antisemitic prejudice but because it was blinded by social distance. Acute awareness of class distinction, a residual mentality from the time when nobility was still the ruling class in society, was deeply entrenched in the thinking habits of Poles throughout the interwar years as well. Even the progressive circles of the intelligentsia were not immune to it. . . . And so. . .all that pertained to war and resistance was sacred ground reserved for the elite of the nation. Once upon a time it was a province of the nobility. Now, the tragic destiny of the country forged in the crucible of the Second World War cast the Polish intelligentsia as the main protagonist. Indeed, it was the intelligentsia's last grand turn on the historical stage where it played a hero (as the repository of patriotic ethos and an architect of wartime resistance); a victim (as Soviet and Nazi occupiers targeted elites for particularly severe persecution); a narrator of current events (through penmanship in the proliferating underground publications) and eventually as interpreter of the experience, its record keeper, and its historian.[8]

Nearly thirty years earlier, in 1985, Gross had observed:

> Despite the dogged persistence of the Poles to reclaim their past, to go beyond, revise, and correct the government-approved version of their history manifested during every mass upheaval in the Polish People's Republic, there was never a temptation to reopen the subject of wartime Polish-Jewish relations. Indeed, a total *curiosum* among important topics in twentieth century Polish history, this one, alone, has not stimulated in the émigré literature or among the uncensored publications a single piece of writing that could not have appeared in a government-owned publishing house in Poland. What could the meaning of such a consensus be but that the matter is settled once and for all and that the record on this issue has been set straight.[9]

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